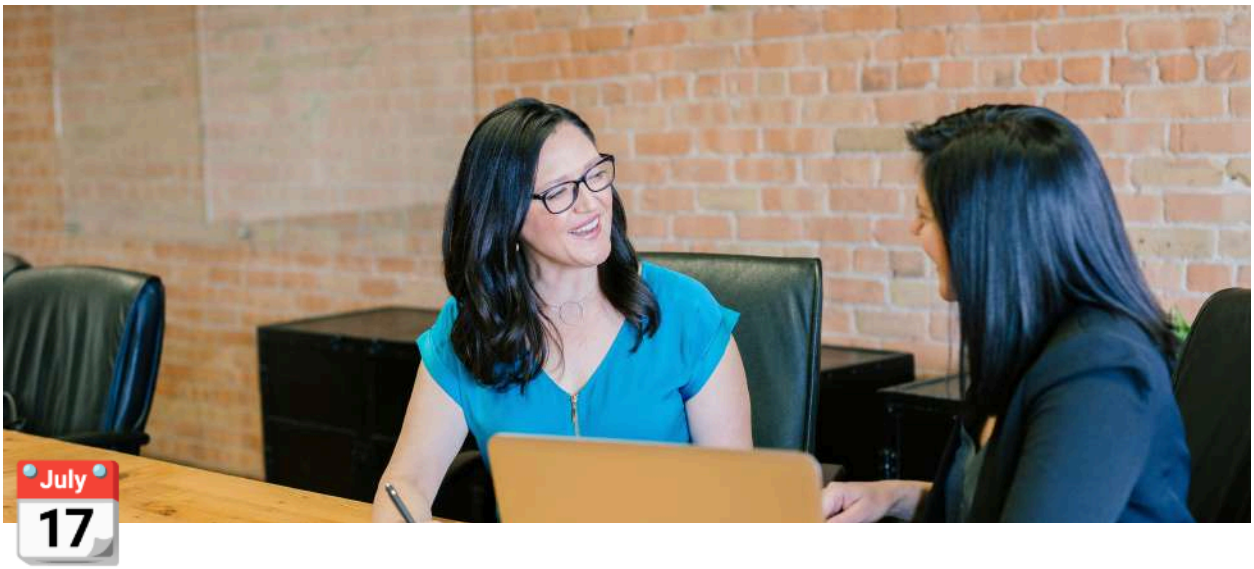

3. Interview Scheduling in CRM

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Phenom CRM was feature rich like capturing qualified leads from career sites, targeting and sending email & SMS campaigns, keeping records of the candidate profiles, tracking their activities and much more. On a competitive analysis among all of Phenom customers, **we figured out that one of the prominent gaps in the Phenom ecosystem was that there was no easy way to schedule interviews with the candidates.**
Today, the recruiters need to go back and forth between the candidates and interviewers to finalise a time slot for the interview to happen.

Team members - **1 UX lead, 1 UX designer and 1 UI designer**

Initial research and inspirations :-

In my initial research, I considered companies like Yello, Microsoft Dynamics, Beamery, Goodtime, Calendly & paradox. Considering the trend in the industry, its user/candidate first approach, meaning, the end user will choose when the interview or meeting can happen.

Problem Statement :-

Design an easy and reliable scheduling solution within the CRM product such that users dont need to depend on an external tool to achieve the same.

Value Proposition

Candidate first scheduling

Our solution was such that we take into consideration, the calendars of the interviewers. As per the free-busy slots on the interviewers calendars, common overlapping free slots are given out to the candidates. The candidates can choose any of these slots.

Propose other times

If none of the provided slots work for the candidate, they can propose another time which can be reviewed by the recruiter.

Easy cancellation and rescheduling

Candidates can cancel or reschedule their interviews easily as per their convenience.

MyAlly Acquisition :-

Considering the tech bandwidth for development, current market positioning and many other factors, Phenom acquired MyAlly, a scheduling platform with the AI capabilities of responding to candidate queries via email.

Because of this, we now had additional capabilities which we needed to incorporate into our solution.

User research :-

We had designed solutions which we initially released. **This version of solution post MyAlly acquisition didn't seem to fit into our customers workflows like it worked for MyAlly customers. There was barely any adoption.**

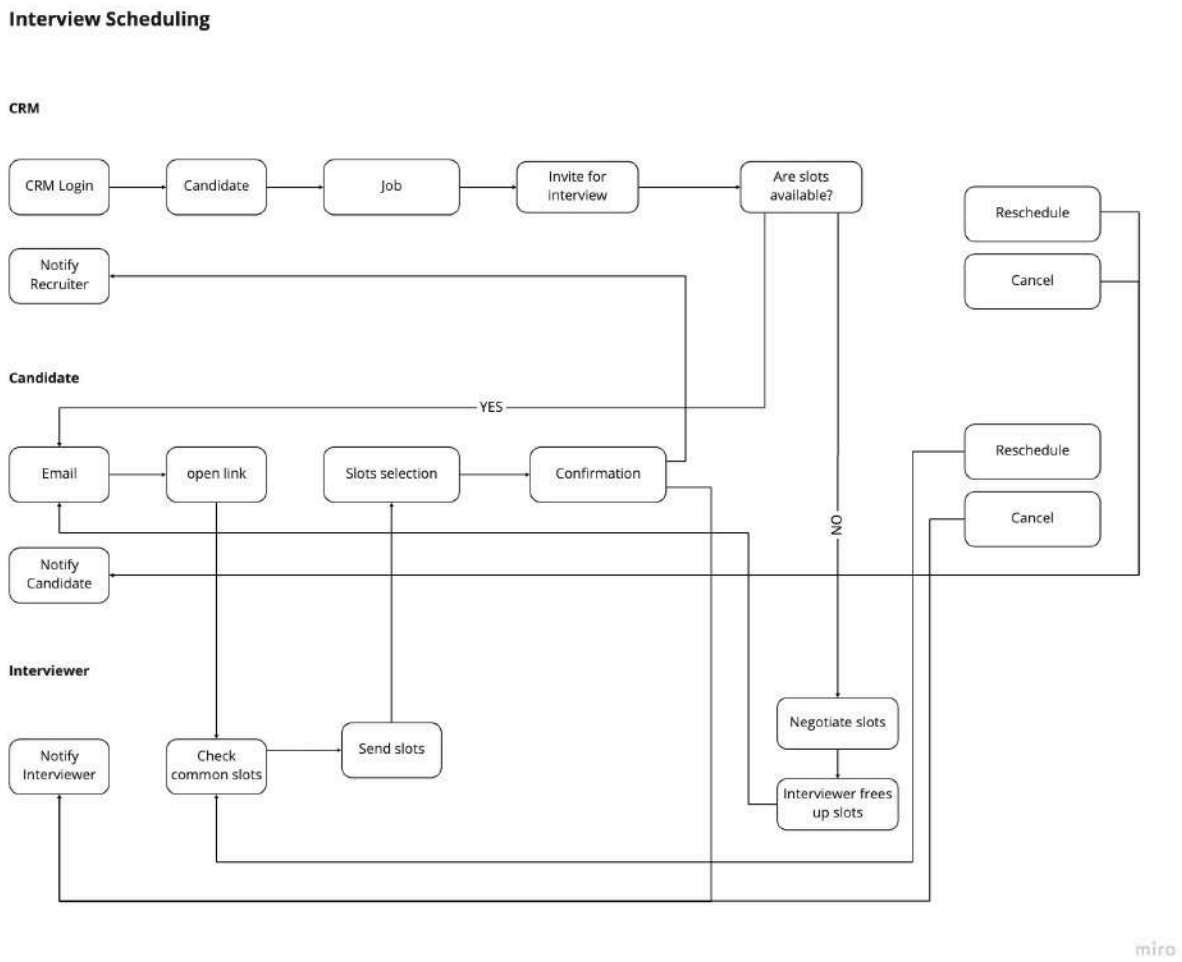
To investigate this further, we concluded on conducting research. We interviewed **5 employees** from different customers.

The key take aways were -

1. Our solution is too technical to use
2. Customers are missing notifications, hence don't trust our AI capabilities enough.
3. All customers are concerned about candidate experience and speed of getting an interview date from the candidates - Hence needed our solution to be glitch free.
4. Some of the customers also had more advanced needs like university recruiting, which requires much complex configurations

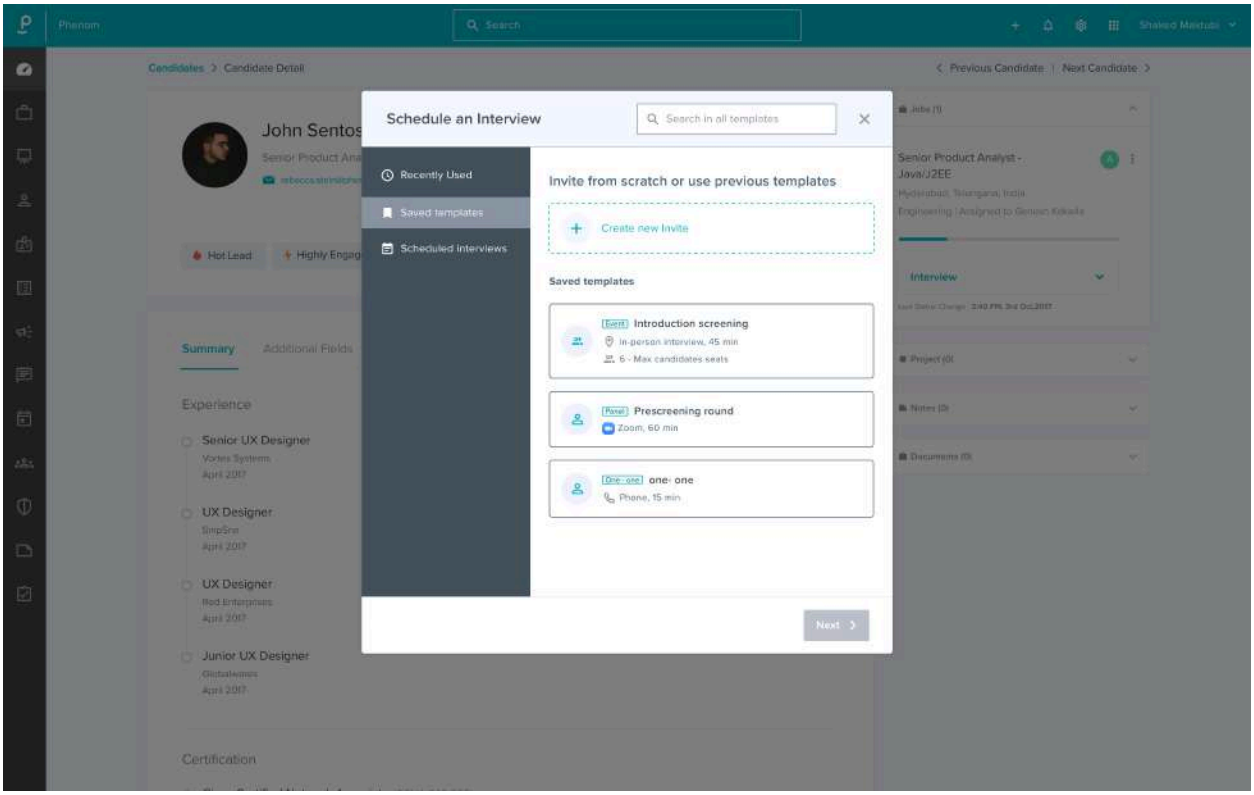
With these inputs, we set out to design a simplified version of scheduling which might better align with the needs of our customers.

Flow :-

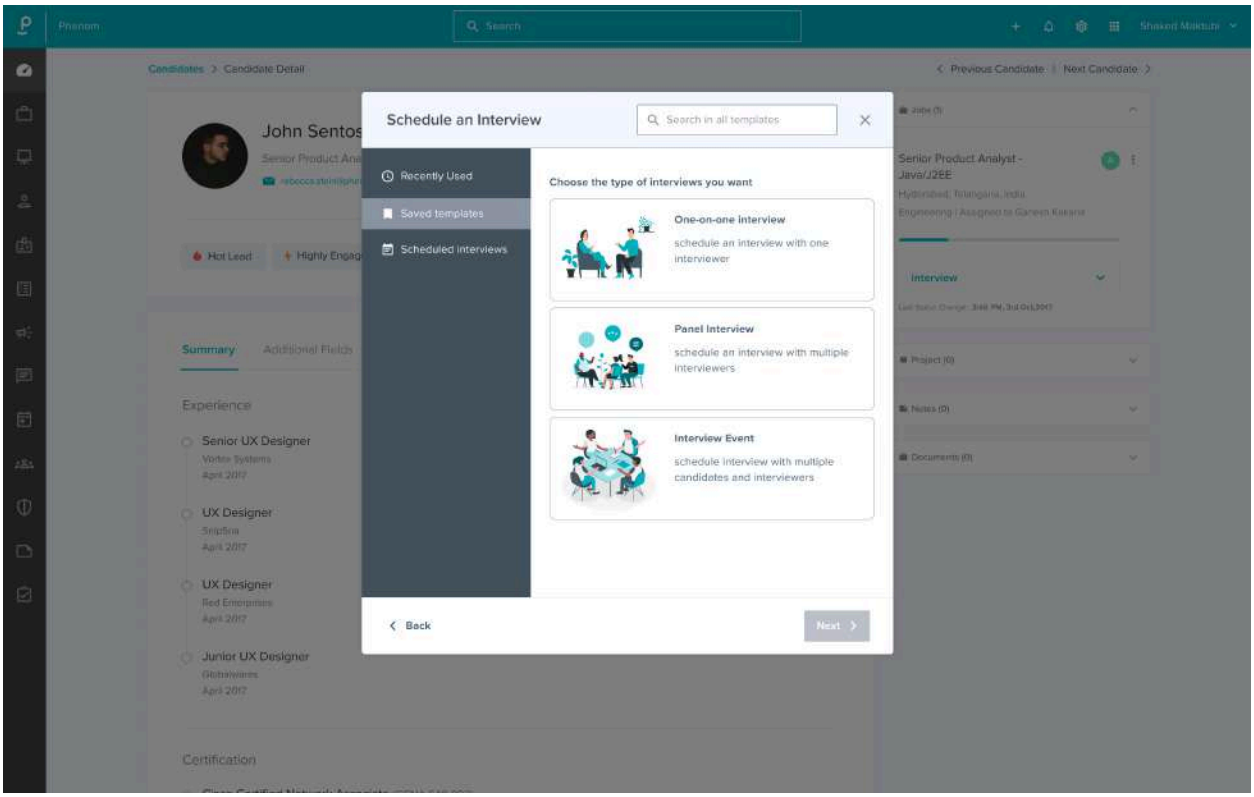


Final design :-

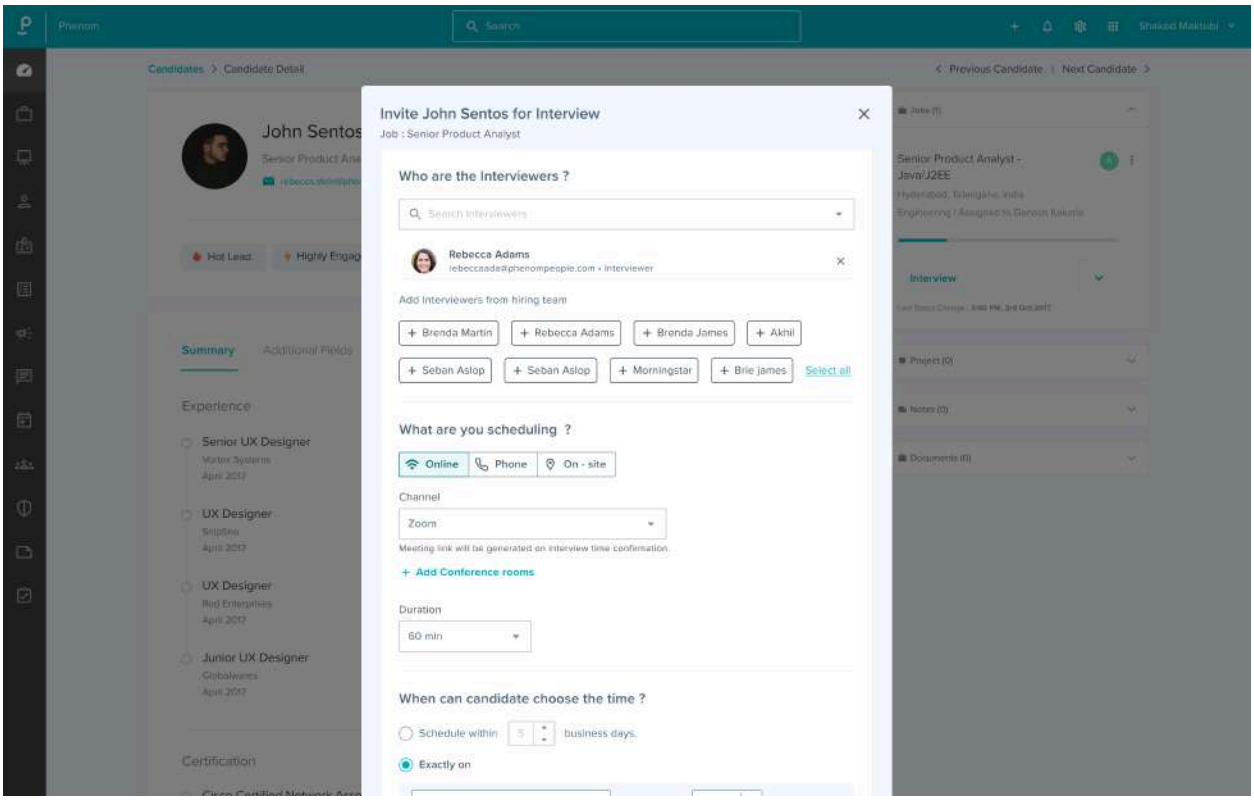
Template selector / Create from scratch

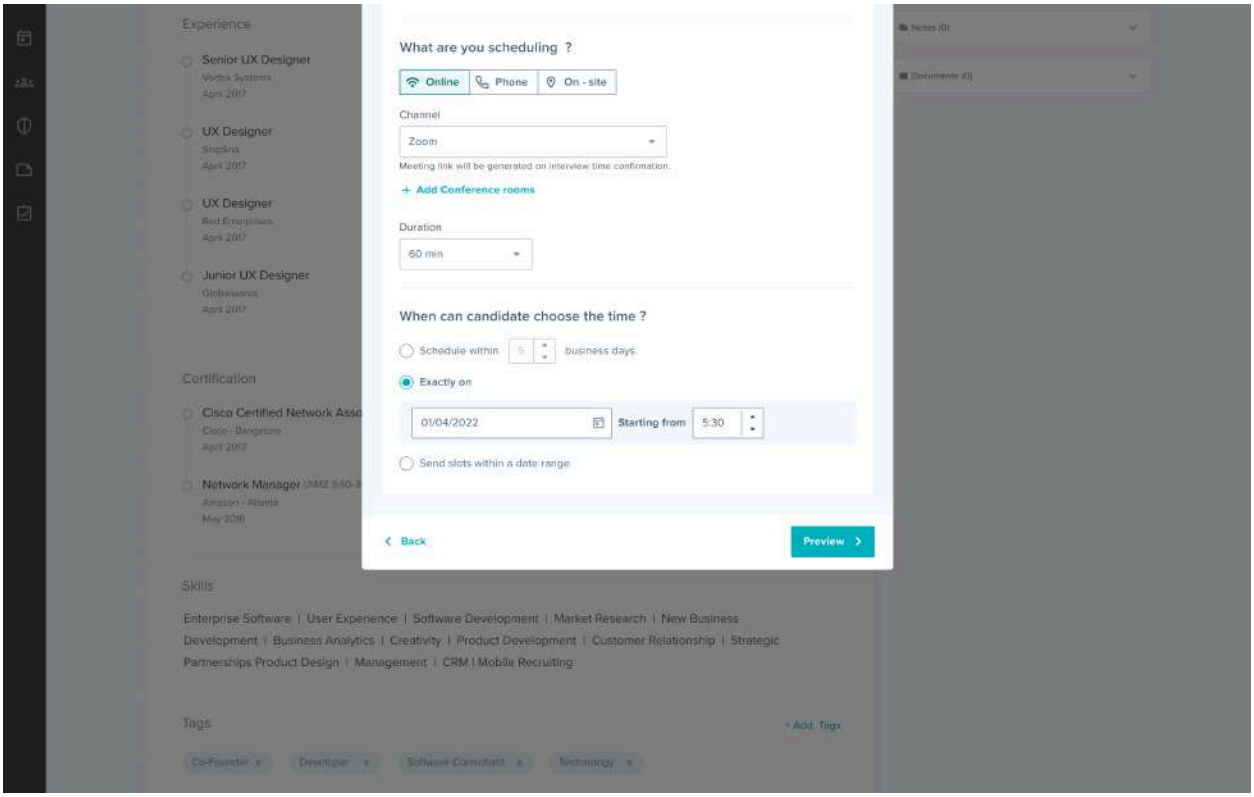


Options on ‘Create new Invite’

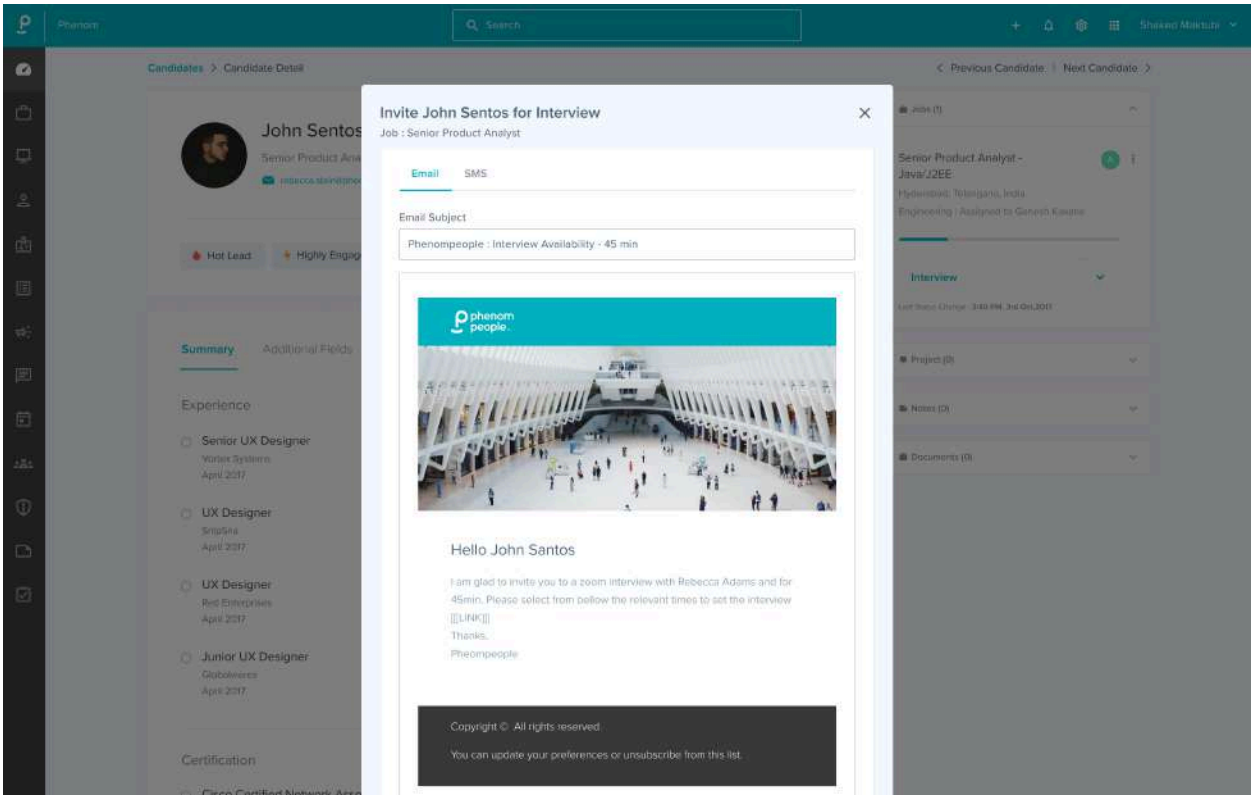


Configuring the details of the interview


Candidates > Candidate Detail
< Previous Candidate | Next Candidate >
John Sentos
Invite John Sentos for Interview
Job : Senior Product Analyst
Who are the Interviewers ?
Rebecca Adams
Add Interviewers from hiring team
+ Brenda Martin
+ Rebecca Adams
+ Brenda James
+ Akhil
+ Seban Aslop
+ Seban Aslop
+ Morningstar
+ Brie james
Select all
What are you scheduling ?
Online
Phone
On - site
Channel
Zoom
Meeting link will be generated on interview time confirmation.
+ Add Conference rooms
Duration
60 min
When can candidate choose the time ?
Schedule within
business days.
Exactly on
Summary
Experience
Senior UX Designer
UX Designer
UX Designer
Junior UX Designer
Certification
Senior Product Analyst - Java/J2EE
Interview

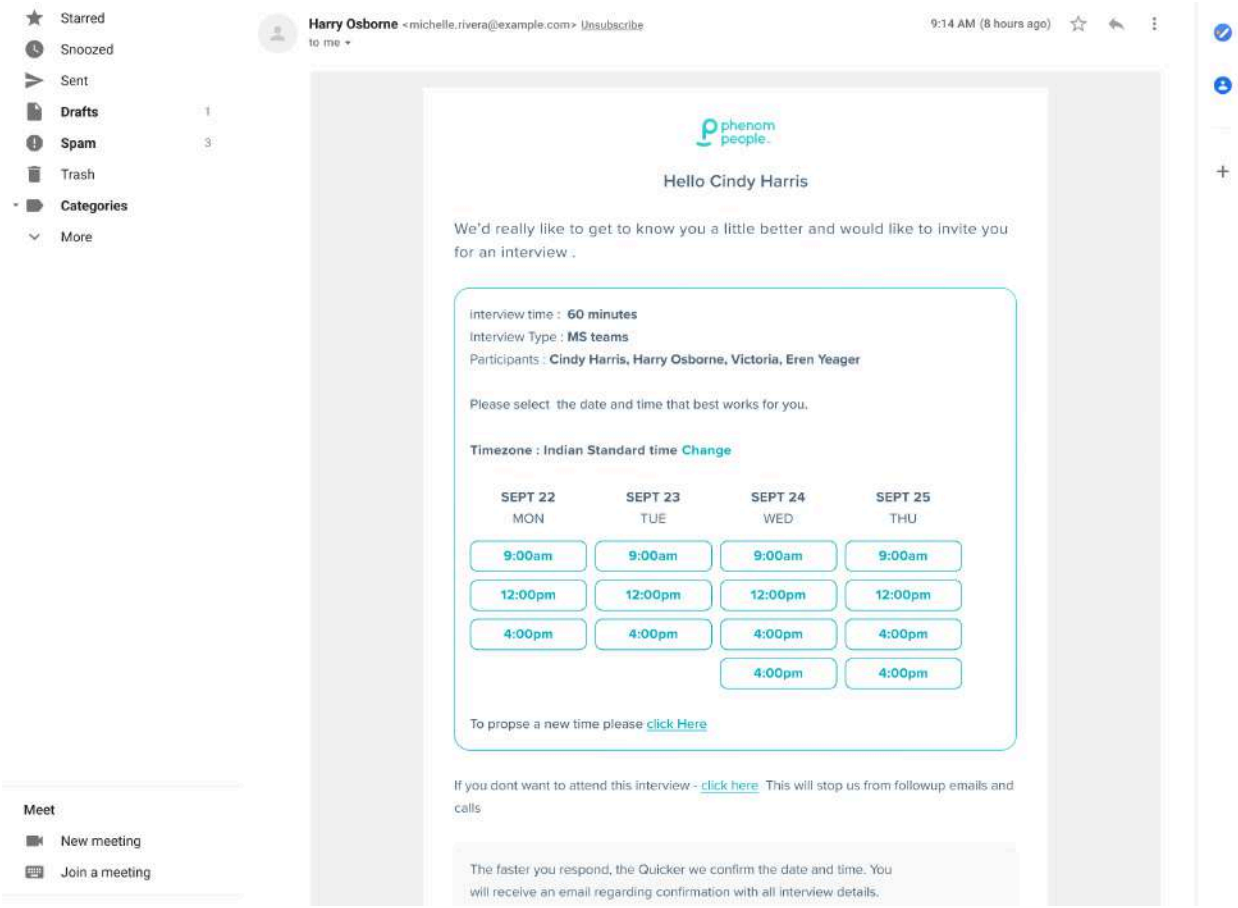

What are you scheduling ?
Online
Phone
On - site
Channel
Zoom
Meeting link will be generated on interview time confirmation.
+ Add Conference rooms
Duration
60 min
When can candidate choose the time ?
Schedule within
business days.
Exactly on
01/04/2022
Starting from
5:30
Send slots within a date range
< Back
Preview >
Experience
Senior UX Designer
UX Designer
UX Designer
Junior UX Designer
Certification
Skills
Enterprise Software | User Experience | Software Development | Market Research | New Business Development | Business Analytics | Creativity | Product Development | Customer Relationship | Strategic Partnerships Product Design | Management | CRM | Mobile Recruiting
Tags
+ Add Tags

Invite preview

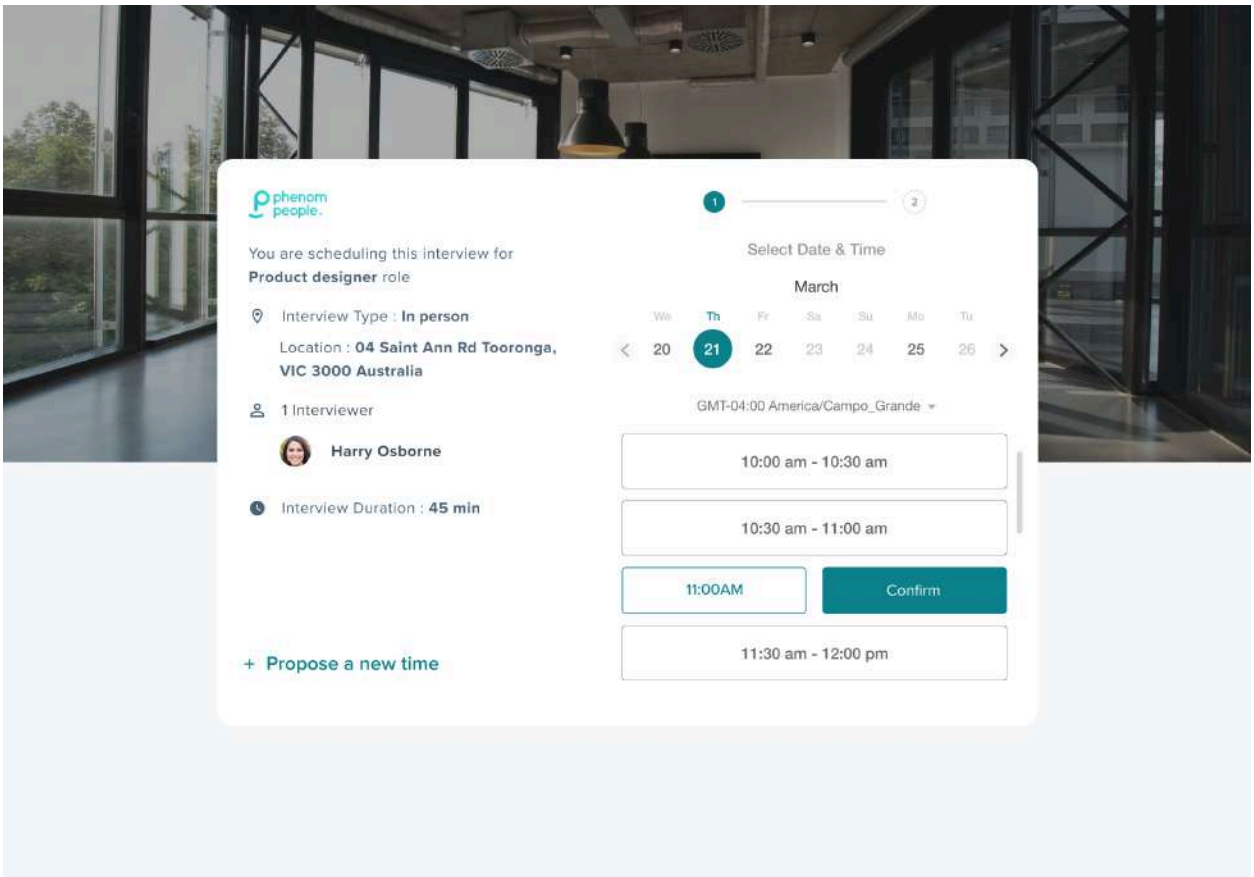


Candidate Experience

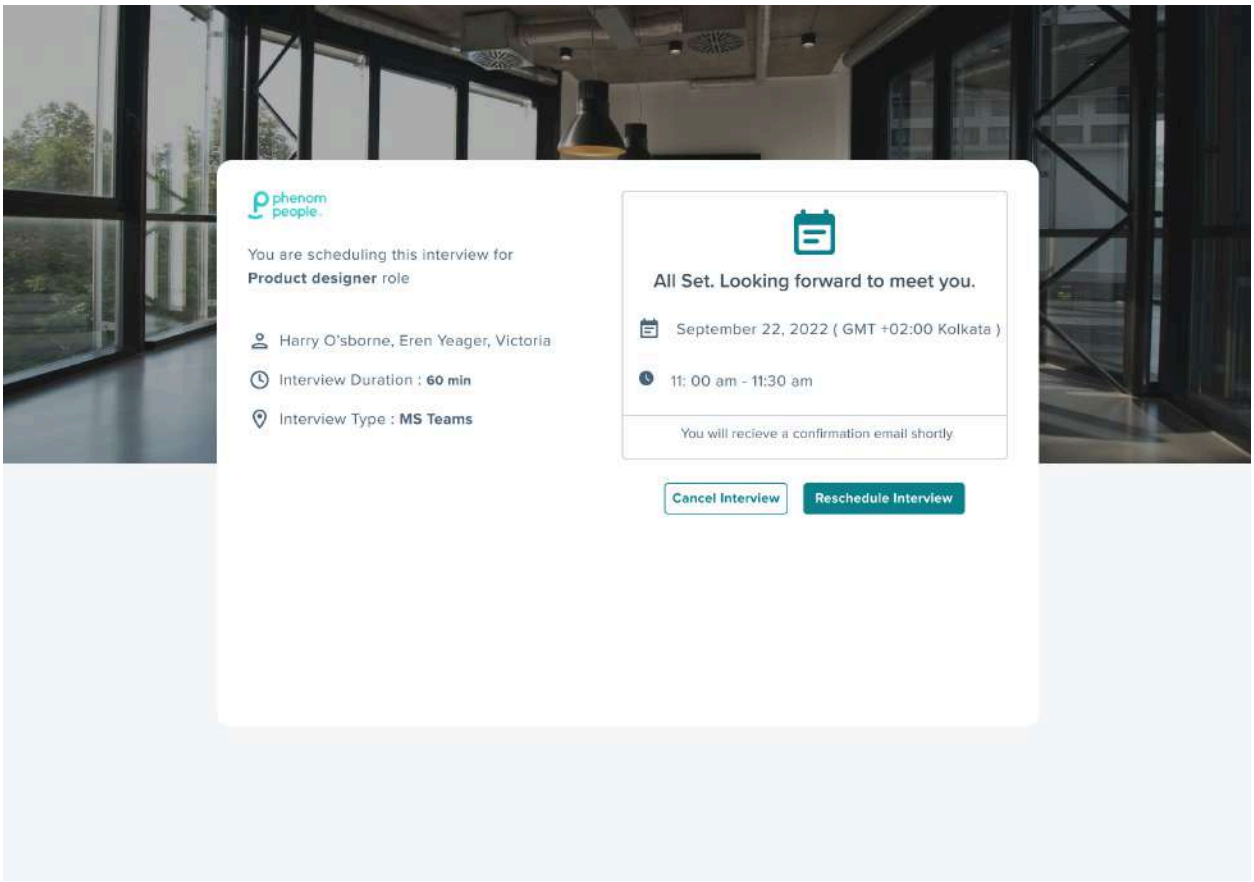
Candidate invite



Candidate slot preference selection



Candidate interview confirmation



Usability testing :-

Once we designed a simplified version (Refer the 'Final design' section) we wanted to make sure this aligns with customer goals. Again we conducted a usability testing with **6 recruiters.** All the issues identified were minor and easily fixable.

Learnings :-

1. **Product conviction**
   One of the major learnings from this entire project was the need to get

conviction early on about the project being done. In the first iteration, our assumption was that MyAlly is already an established solution and that we simply incorporate that into our product. This backfired badly.

2. **Acquisitions can be messy**
   It was indeed a great learning experience to be on ground while incorporating the acquisition into Phenom. Got to witness a lot of chaos, lack of direction, lack of product clarity and to fight it all to build a good product.

3. **Usability testing to get validation**
   After the initial failure of the product, we desperately wanted to make sure we get it right this time. For this, usability testing became extremely crucial to get initial validation. Otherwise the entire product can become a very expensive affair.

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